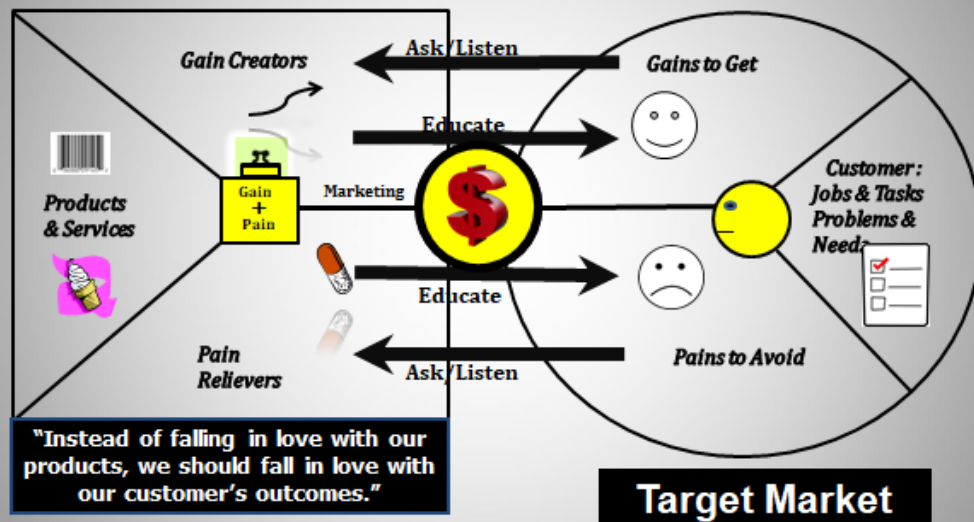


The Success Proposition Canvas



Typically, we think in terms of customers having certain problems or tasks, so we focus on describing the features and benefits when marketing our products and services. When we aren't selling enough, we tend to get seduced into thinking we need to tweak and modify our product. The reality is that customers buy our products and services to create a gain or avoid a pain.

As business owners, we rarely ask what pains or gains our customers are dealing with. Even rarer is the customer who can accurately and precisely articulate these pains and gains

If we are able to discern the real pain and gain conversations customers are having in their head, we can "package" and communicate about our products and services so that we are meeting the customer's emotional needs. Said another way, customers have a fear about some pain or a hope around some gain.

Raving fans and addicted customers are not created by product enhancement but rather by meeting their emotional needs of gain creation (hope) and pain avoidance (fear).

The primary keys to this strategy are:

1. Be a detective.
2. Ask customers lots of questions.
3. Listen closely to the answers and the reasoning/explanations. Listen for fears and hopes.
4. Develop a communication strategy that wraps your product or service in a “package” which addresses the customer’s hopes and fears.
5. Training and retraining sales and marketing personnel on the process of finding gains and pains is far more critical than extreme product knowledge.

Here it is on a bumper sticker: Instead of falling in love with our products, we should fall in love with our customer’s outcomes and emotional needs.

Question: How might I create a Value Proposition that focuses on a Gain Creator or Pain Reliever so that my target market has less risk, less friction, is clear on the difference that makes the difference and meets their definition of success?